

16-29 October 1962**THE CUBAN MISSILE CRISIS**

Responding to US deployments in Turkey and Italy, Soviet premier Nikita Khrushchev sought to site missiles in Cuba, near the US mainland. The US demanded the weapons' removal under threat of military reprisal. A potential nuclear confrontation was avoided when Khrushchev withdrew the missiles.

▽ **US and Russian naval ships meet** off Puerto Rico

**25 May 1963****ORGANISATION OF AFRICAN UNITY (OAU) FORMED**

At a gathering in the Ethiopian capital Addis Ababa, representatives of 32 African nations came together to form a body dedicated to improving political and economic co-operation and confronting colonialism. The lack of any military wing limited the ability of the organization to enforce its decisions, and in 2002 it was replaced by the 55-member African Union.

◁ **Delegates** attend the first session of the OAU

5 August 1963 A partial Nuclear Test Ban Treaty is signed by the Soviet Union, the US, and the UK

1963

1962 US troops are sent to Vietnam to support South Vietnamese forces against North Vietnamese insurgents

20 October 1962 Military conflict breaks out between China and India

July 1963 Links between the Chinese and Soviet Communist parties are formally severed

22 November 1963
US PRESIDENT JOHN F. KENNEDY IS ASSASSINATED

Almost three years into his term of office, Kennedy travelled to Dallas, Texas, on a political mission. While riding in a motorcade through the streets, he was shot twice by an assassin stationed on the sixth floor of a roadside building. The killing had a profound effect on the nation, and conspiracy theories about the motives behind the assassination spread for many years afterwards. In its wake, Vice President Lyndon B. Johnson took office as the 36th US President.



△ **John F. Kennedy** in the presidential motorcade moments before his assassination